

Task 11 – Basic Data Sorting & Filtering

Superstore Dataset Analysis Report

1. Objective

To practice basic data sorting and filtering using a Superstore retail dataset and identify useful business insights from Sales and Profit data.

2. Dataset

Dataset used: SampleSuperstore.csv. The dataset contains retail transaction information such as Ship Mode, Segment, City, State, Region, Category, Sub-Category, Sales, Quantity, Discount, and Profit. The raw dataset was preserved unchanged while a working copy was used for analysis.

3. Work Completed

- Created a working Excel copy of the dataset.
- Converted the data range into an Excel Table with filter dropdowns.
- Applied sorting from largest to smallest where required.
- Used filters for Category, Region, Sub-Category, and Segment.
- Used the SUBTOTAL function to calculate totals for filtered records.
- Created a separate 'Task 11 Answers' sheet to present the findings.

4. Business Questions & Findings

Question	Finding
Highest Sales Category	Technology
Highest Profit Region	West
Highest Sales Sub-Category	Phones
Highest Sales Segment	Consumer
Highest Profit Category	Technology

5. Excel Formula Used

=SUBTOTAL(9,J2:J9995) was used to calculate the visible Sales total after filtering. For Profit, the corresponding Profit column was summed with **=SUBTOTAL(9,M2:M9995)**. SUBTOTAL is useful because filtered-out rows are excluded from the calculation.

6. Key Learning Outcomes

- Learned how to convert raw data into an Excel Table.
- Practiced sorting and filtering large datasets.
- Learned how filtered totals can be calculated using SUBTOTAL.
- Learned to separate raw data from analysis results.
- Practiced turning transaction data into simple business insights.

7. Conclusion

Task 11 provided practical experience in organizing, sorting, filtering, and summarizing retail data. The analysis identified the categories, region, sub-category, and segment associated with the highest Sales or Profit totals in the dataset.